

Stephen Zweibel

Digital Scholarship Librarian, Associate Professor · The Graduate Center, City University of New York

Mina Rees Library, Room 2313 · 365 Fifth Avenue, New York, NY 10016 · szweibel@gc.cuny.edu · zweibel.net

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CUNY Graduate Center

Digital Scholarship Librarian, Associate Professor

Spring 2016–present

(Data & Digital Projects Librarian, Lecturer, Aug 2015–Spring 2016)

- Provide expertise on AI literacy and generative AI integration in academic libraries, including policy development, evaluation frameworks, and pedagogical applications
- Advise the CUNY Office of Library Services on AI in research and discovery systems, including vendor evaluation across the CUNY libraries
- Support, coordinate, collaborate, and consult with faculty and students on digital research projects
- Write scripts and create applications that automate processes for the library
- Lead library workshops on research and technology, and embed in classrooms to teach digital techniques
- Lead the Web Team, determining website design and functionality
- Take primary responsibility for developing, maintaining, implementing changes in library website
- Act as institutional expert on computer programming in the humanities
- Advise researchers and grant applicants on data management
- Provide regular reference support and subject liaison work, including collection development, for the following programs/topics: Computational Linguistics, Data Science, Data Visualization, Demography, Digital Humanities, Geography/GIS

CUNY AI Lab

Co-Founder and Co-Director

2025–present

- Co-founded the Lab with Stefano Morello and Zach Muhlbauer; the Lab is run jointly by GC Digital Initiatives, the Teaching and Learning Center, the Mina Rees Library, and the American Social History Project
- Designed and built the CAIL Gateway for shared model access, routing, policy, attribution, and quotas
- Built and maintain the Lab's public tool suite, including Agent Studio, Site Studio, and PDF accessibility
- Guide the work and priorities of the Lab's fellows

Hunter College

Visiting Lecturer

Oct. 2012–Aug. 2015

- Planned, built, and deployed a mobile, responsive library catalog for CUNY+, including custom API
- Developed a web application to track and analyze reference data (frequency, length, and nature of questions) to inform personnel and resource management; in use across Hunter College Libraries
- Wrote a macro to automate catalog record deletion, saving thousands of hours of cataloging labor
- Provided reference research service to graduates and undergraduates at the Health Professions Library
- Taught information literacy classes to students on search strategy: Medline, CINAHL, APA, Refworks, Zotero
- Led workshops to teach programming (Python, JavaScript) to CUNY librarians

Adjunct Reference Librarian

Sep. 2010–Oct. 2012

- Developed and piloted an RFID book inventory solution, using a programmable microcontroller

New York University

Adjunct Reference/Cataloging/Virtual Reference Librarian

Sep. 2010–Jan. 2013

- Provided reference service to students, faculty, and staff at Bobst Library
- Answered virtual reference questions via email, IM, and text
- Created original catalog records for the Tamiment Library collection of rare radical literature

Columbia University

Intern, Special Collections Metadata and Cataloging

Nov. 2009–Aug. 2010

- Designed project to reclaim 'lost' items in collections, wrote instructional documents for implementation
- Generated original and copy catalog records for the Gillette collection of rare 17th and 18th century pamphlets
- Cataloged the Avery Library's collection of architectural literature

EDUCATION

- **Master of Arts in Liberal Studies, Digital Humanities Track**, CUNY Graduate Center, February 2016
- **Master of Science in Library Information Science**, Palmer School of Long Island University, June 2010
- **Bachelor of Liberal Arts**, St. John's College, May 2008

GRANTS & AWARDS

- **Principal Investigator:** Provost's Innovation Grant for "Enhancing Web Accessibility Through Multimodal LLM Analysis", 2025. **\$10,000**
- **Co-Principal Investigator:** National Endowment of the Humanities Digital Humanities Advancement Grant for DHRIFT, 2023. **\$300,000**
- **Manager of Open Educational Resources:** National Endowment of the Humanities Advancement for Digital Humanities Research Institute, 2019. **\$250,000**
- **Coordinator, Workshop Leader:** National Endowment of the Humanities Start-up Grant for Digital Humanities Research Institute, 2017. **\$60,000**
- **Co-Principal Investigator:** National Endowment of the Humanities Start-Up Grant for DH Box, 2015. **\$60,000**
- **Principal Investigator:** ACERT Faculty Innovations in Teaching with Technology Grant, 2014. **\$2,000**

PUBLICATIONS

Peer Reviewed Publications

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| 2026 | Zweibel, S. Do Artifacts Still Have Politics? Technological Determinism and Professional Agency in Academic Libraries' AI Transformation. <i>portal: Libraries and the Academy</i> 26(3):495–512. https://doi.org/10.1353/pla.2026.a994555 |
| 2022 | Zweibel, S. Automating reference consultation requests with JavaScript and a Google Form. <i>Code4Lib Journal</i> 55. |
| 2020 | Shirazi, R. and Zweibel, S. Documenting digital projects: Instituting guidelines for digital dissertations and theses. <i>College and Research Libraries</i> 81(7). |
| 2020 | Zweibel, S. Scraping BePress: Downloading Dissertations for Preservation. <i>Code4Lib Journal</i> 47. |

Invited Publications

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| 2012 | Zweibel, S., and Lane, Z. (2012). Probing the Effects of Policy Changes by Evaluating Circulation Activity Data at Columbia University Libraries. <i>The Serials Librarian</i> 63(1):17–27. |
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Professional Guidelines

- 2025 Zweibel, S. (Chair & Author). Evaluating AI Tools in Research Systems. CUNY Libraries Research Artificial Intelligence Task Force. Approved by CUNY Office of Library Services, October 2025.

Open Educational Resources

- 2026 Zweibel, S. *Working with AI Coding Tools: Guides for Librarians and Researchers*. CC BY 4.0.
<https://zweibel.net/ai-tools-oer/>

Other Publications

- 2026 Running the CUNY AI Lab on Open Weights. *CUNY AI Lab* blog, July 20, 2026 (published under the Lab's byline). <https://ailab.gc.cuny.edu/blog/running-on-open-weights/>
- 2017 Zweibel, S., & Smyth, P. (2017). DH Box and Access in the Digital Humanities. *dh+lib*.
<https://acrl.ala.org/dh/2017/06/21/dh-box-and-access-in-the-digital-humanities/>

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

Instruction

- 2026 “Practical JavaScript for Interactive Scholarship.” Invited workshop, with Zachary Lloyd. Digital Humanities Summer Institute 2026 (June 8–12), Montreal, CA.
- 2025 “Introduction to JavaScript.” Invited workshop. Digital Humanities Summer Institute 2025, Montreal, CA.
- 2024 “Web APIs with Python.” Invited workshop. Digital Humanities Summer Institute 2024 (June 10–14), Victoria, BC, CA.
- 2019 “Web APIs with Python.” Invited workshop. Digital Humanities Summer Institute 2019 (June 3–14), Victoria, BC, CA.
- 2018 “Web APIs with Python.” Invited workshop. Digital Humanities Summer Institute 2018 (June 4–15), Victoria, BC, CA.

Invited Talks

- 2026 “What Is Agentic Programming?” Critical Psychology Colloquium, CUNY Graduate Center, October 8, 2026, New York, NY.
- 2021 ACRL ETD Formatting User's Group, June 2021.
- 2015 DH Box lightning talk. Invited presentation at CUNY Graduate Center, November 2015, New York, NY.
- 2015 “Know Thy Shelf.” Invited presentation at Columbia Library, May 2015, New York, NY.
- 2014 “DH Box: A Computer Lab in the Cloud.” Invited presentation at Hunter ACERT, May 2014, New York, NY.

Invited Panels

- 2026 “Human Perspectives on Teaching and Learning in the Age of AI.” Fireside chat, Bronx EdTech Showcase 2026 (May 1), Bronx Community College, Bronx, NY. Panelist.
- 2018 “Assessment in Reference” LACUNY Assessment Fair 2018 (April), New York, NY. Panelist.
- 2016 “Ideas in Circulation: Open Scholarship for Social Justice” CUNY Graduate Center 2016 (February), New York, NY. Moderator.

Peer-Reviewed Panels

- 2026 “Harnessing Agentic AI: Tools for Open University Infrastructure.” In “Building Community-Oriented Infrastructures for AI Experimentation.” ACH 2026 (June 24–26), virtual. Panelist.
- 2025 “What Happens When ‘Hacking’ Becomes Easy? Teaching Python in 2025.” Digital Humanities 2025 (July 14–18), Lisbon, Portugal. Panelist.
- 2019 “Digital Humanities Research Institute.” ACH 2019 (July 23–26), Pittsburgh, PA. Panelist.
- 2017 “DH Box.” In “Open Source Lit, Open Source Crit.” MLA 2017 (January 5–8), Philadelphia, PA. Panelist.

Poster Presentations

- 2024 “DHRIFT: Digital Humanities Resource Infrastructure for Teaching Technology.” With Lisa Rhody. Poster (peer-reviewed published proceedings). Digital Humanities 2024 (August 6–9), Washington, D.C.
- 2017 “DH Box.” With Jojo Karlin, Patrick Smyth. Poster (peer-reviewed published proceedings). Digital Humanities 2017 (August 8–11), Montreal, CA.
- 2016 “Crafting the Digital Front Matter: Guidelines for Depositing Digital Dissertations.” With Roxanne Shirazi. Poster presented at the US Electronic Thesis and Dissertation Association (USETDA) Conference 2016 (September 25–28), Columbus, OH.
- 2016 “DH Box: Building Cloud-Based Infrastructure for the Digital Humanities.” With Jojo Karlin, Patrick Smyth. Poster presented at the Canadian Society for Digital Humanities 2016 (May 28–June 3), Calgary, Alberta, CA.

Presentations

- 2026 “Evaluating AI in Library Discovery.” Presentation to CUNY librarians, New York, NY.
- 2015 “DH Box: A Push-Button Computer Lab.” Presented at METRO Annual Conference 2015, New York, NY.
- 2014 “DH Box: A Push-Button Computer Lab.” Presented at CUNY 13th Annual IT Conference 2014 (December), New York, NY.
- 2013 “Life with Pi: Microcomputing in Academia.” Presented at CUNY 12th Annual IT Conference 2013 (December), New York, NY.
- 2013 “Augur for Reference Desk Statistics.” Presented at METRO Reference SIG 2013 (September), New York, NY.
- 2013 “Building a Library Catalog API.” Presented at METRO Code4Lib SIG 2013 (April), New York, NY.

WEB AND APPLICATION/TOOL DEVELOPMENT

- 2025–present CUNY AI Lab Gateway: shared model access, routing, policy, attribution, and quotas
- 2025–present CUNY AI Lab public tool suite (tools.ailab.gc.cuny.edu): Agent Studio, Site Studio, Kale Deploy
- 2025–present PDF Accessibility App: accessibility validation and AI-assisted tagging for CUNY Academic Works
- 2025–present AI Reference Agent for the Mina Rees Library (prototype), and the Library Agent Gateway that extends it to other library systems
- 2025–26 CV-to-CSV, a faculty scholarship extraction tool used by the GC Office of Institutional Research and Effectiveness
- 2026 Omeka S platform for the Center for the Humanities Digital Archive, with Roxanne Shirazi
- 2026 Graduate Center dissertation collection in Omeka, built from 12,083 ETD records

2023–25	DHRIFT: Digital Humanities Resource Infrastructure for Teaching Technology
2019–21	DHRI Curriculum website
2018–19	Redesign of CUNY Graduate Center Library website
2014–19	DH Box, digital humanities laboratory in the cloud
2013–16	Augur, reference desk statistics tracking application
2013	CUNY+ mobile catalog
2012	Know Thy Shelf, RFID library inventory solution using microcontroller

TEACHING

Graduate Courses

- **Introduction to JavaScript** (DATA 70600 / DHUM 70600)
 - Spring semesters, CUNY Graduate Center
 - Project-oriented introduction to JavaScript for humanities and social science graduate students
 - Topics: JavaScript fundamentals, web development, data visualization with libraries (Leaflet, jQuery)
- **Python for Researchers** (Fall 2025)
 - Fall semesters, CUNY Graduate Center
 - Project-oriented introduction to Python for academic research
 - Topics: Python fundamentals, data analysis with pandas, APIs, Jupyter notebooks, visualization, AI-assisted coding practices
- **AI-Assisted Programming** (DHUM 78000 / DATA 78000, Spring 2026; DHUM 70600 / DATA 70600, Fall 2026)
 - CUNY Graduate Center; the Fall 2026 offering is a one-credit lab
 - Graduate students build and investigate working projects with agentic coding tools
 - Topics: Code investigation techniques, AI coding assistants, debugging, verification, technical agency

Professional Development Programs

- **Agentic AI for Library Practice** (CUNY Office of Library Services)
 - January–May 2026
 - Sixteen-week peer mentoring program in which fifteen CUNY librarians used agentic AI coding tools on projects from their own work

WORKSHOPS/EMBEDDING

Special Workshops

2019–24	Data for Public Good Fellowship
2017–present	Digital Humanities Research Institute

Other Drop-in and Course-Specific Workshops

The Command Line; Python; JavaScript; Data Management; Databases; APIs (Application Programming Interfaces); HTML, CSS; Text Analysis; Agentic AI Coding Tools; Introduction to Research for Master's Students; Citation Management

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Refereeing

2025	Reviewer for GC Provost's Digital Innovation Grant proposals
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2024	Reviewer for NEH DH grants
2019	Reviewer for Library Information Technology Association book proposal
2018	Reviewer for Journal of Interactive Technology and Pedagogy
2017	Reviewer for GC Provost's Digital Innovation Grant proposals
2016	Reviewer for NEH DH grants
2016	Reviewer for GC PDIG proposals

Committees, Roundtables, and Working Groups

- Chair, CUNY Libraries Research Artificial Intelligence Task Force (2024–25)
 - Authored “Evaluating AI Tools in Research Systems”, approved as official CUNY policy (October 2025)
 - Point of contact for CUNY libraries applying the policy in vendor negotiations (2025–present)
- Convener, GC Library AI Working Group (2025–present)
- CUNY Office of Library Services Discovery Working Group (2025–26)
- Library Appointments Committee, Graduate Center Library (2025–26)
- CUNY Graduate Center IT Committee (2017–present)
- CUNY Libraries Alma Analytics Working Group (2019–20)
- LACUNY Executive Council (2015–17)
- Chair, LACUNY Emerging Technology Committee (2013–15)
- Digital Preservation Working Group, Graduate Center Library (2018–present)
- Chair, Web Services Steering Committee, Graduate Center Library (2016–present)

SKILLS

Programming: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, PHP

AI Infrastructure: Model access gateways, model evaluation, agentic coding tools

CMSs and Digital Repositories: WordPress, Drupal, Omeka, Blackboard

Database Management: MySQL, Access

Library Management Systems: Ex Libris Alma and Primo, Ex Libris Aleph, OCLC Connexion, EZproxy, Voyager

Cataloging: Dublin Core, RDA, MODS, MARC21, AACR2

Languages: French (Intermediate), Ancient Greek (Reading)

Professional Memberships: ALA, ACRL

Last updated: October 2026